navy, air force, air defense, and army. Their main task was to enable the deployment and ensure the protection of four missile regiments, two equipped with twenty-four launchers of R-12 medium-range missiles and two with sixteen launchers of R-14 intermediate-range missiles. The forty launchers were to be provided with sixty missiles and sixty warheads.

When it came to time requirements for such an operation—another question addressed to Malinovsky and Biriuzov by the Defense Council—Gribkov suggested that the missiles could be sent to Cuba in two shipments, starting in early July. The concentration of the entire task force in Cuba could be completed by September. Gribkov and his assistants estimated that the R-12 missiles with prefabricated launchpads could be rendered operational within ten days after arrival at the designated location. The construction of launch facilities for the R-14s, however, would take about four months. Thus the R-12s could become operational in September and the R-14s by the end of December 1962. Apart from detailed enumeration of the weaponry, equipment, and units needed for the operation, the draft document suggested a name for the supersecret operation—Anadyr.[7]

Gribkov never revealed whose idea it was to name the Soviet deployment in tropical Cuba after a Siberian river in the Chukotka Peninsula, separated by a narrow stretch of water from Alaska, but the choice of name left no doubt that the planners took the secrecy of the operation seriously. They also showed tremendous daring: delivering to Cuba and then secretly deploying forty missile launchers, sixty missiles, and sixty nuclear warheads along with forty-five thousand personnel and escort was a task bordering on the impossible. Nevertheless, Minister of Defense Malinovsky duly signed the document prepared by Gribkov. Khrushchev's half-baked idea had taken on the specifics of a military plan. The military were going for the kill: they were about to create a full-fledged military base in Cuba, and the proposed name of the task force, the Group of Soviet Armed Forces in Cuba, mirrored the name of the Soviet forces in East Germany, suggesting a dramatic extension of the Soviet western military frontier all the way to the Caribbean.[8]

On May 24, Marshal Malinovsky presented Gribkov's proposal to the Central Committee Presidium, largely the same group of Soviet plenipotentiaries as the one that constituted the Defense Council. Those